

worth nothing. It's literally a pretty rock.

Diamonds have no resale value.

The reason a "diamond is forever" is because you're basically stuck with it. You'll never be able to resell it except to a pawn shop. Even a jeweler (the few who would be willing to buy it) would offer a fraction of what you paid.

Synthetic diamonds will flood the market. Synthetic or "cultured" diamonds are already being made and within the next few years, will be efficiently made for the mass market. These are real diamonds. They are made in a machine that replicates the environmental forces that make diamonds. The only difference is that they're better. They have less flaws. And they cost a fraction of the going rate. Want a 2-carat pink diamond? That'll be a few thousand dollars.

Moissanite looks just like a diamond. Jewelers had to upgrade their equipment to detect Moissanite from diamonds when it came into the market. It's undetectable with the naked eye. And it's actually more brilliant. A 1-carat ring is under \$1,000.

Who is the ring for, anyway?

Seriously. It's fun to show off for about 30 seconds. After that there is little to show for the debt incurred for the shiny piece of rock. That money could have gone into furniture, an

amazing trip (or many nice ones), or your future kids' college funds!

What are conflict/blood diamonds? Conflict/blood diamonds are used by rebel groups to fuel conflict and civil wars, and by terrorist groups to finance their activities.

The Kimberley Process is just PR. The Kimberley Process is an agreement that is supposed to prevent conflict diamonds from getting into the market but ended up being more of a PR stunt since it's based on a system of self-policing. The UN reported in October 2006 that due to poor enforcement of the Kimberley Process, \$23 million of conflict diamonds from Côte d'Ivoire alone entered the legitimate market.

Jennifer Connelly says in the movie *Blood Diamond*, "People back home change to: 'wouldn't buy a ring' if they knew it cost someone else their hand." Now you know. — **Lynn Truong**

How to Complain and Get a Good Result

As a professional advertising copywriter I've learned a thing or two